Max Alston

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Placement director	Gianluca Violante	violante@princeton.edu	609-258-4003
Graduate administrator	Laura Hedden	lhedden@princeton.edu	609-258-4006

Office contact information

Julis Romo Rabinowitz Building
Department of Economics
Princeton University
Princeton, NJ 08544

Education

Princeton University *2021 – present*

Ph.D. in Economics (expected completion: May 2027)
M.A. in Economics

The Australian National University *2014 – 2017*

B. Politics, Philosophy and Economics
B. Economics (First Class Honours with the University Medal)

References

Moritz Lenel	Atif Mian	Gianluca Violante
Department of Economics	Department of Economics	Department of Economics
Princeton University	Princeton University	Princeton University
lenel@princeton.edu	atif@princeton.edu	violante@princeton.edu

Fields

Macroeconomics and finance

Job market paper

"Household credit, risk premia and consumption."

I study how risk premia transmit to aggregate consumption. While prior work emphasizes links from capital prices to consumption, I argue for a distinct channel: household credit conditions. I build a quantitative macro model with capital, risky household debt and shocks to risk premia. Analytically, I show cross-sectional consumption data distinguish between propagation channels. Empirically, consumption growth comoves most strongly with risk premia for households with consumer credit. Quantitatively, the model replicates the aggregate and cross-sectional consumption responses to changes in risk premia. Changes in household credit conditions account for most high-frequency consumption volatility. After a contractionary financial shock, policymakers face a trade-off between short-term consumption support and the speed of the recovery.

Working papers

"Production and pricing of safe assets." with Rafael Gonçalves and Moritz Lenel

"Government debt maturity and monetary policy." with Antonio Giribaldi

Publications

Academic

"On the non-existence of stable matches with incomplete information." *Games and Economic Behavior*, 2020.

Policy writing

"The Term Funding Facility." with Sue Black, Ben Jackman and Carl Schwartz, *RBA Bulletin*, December 2020.

"Developments in Emerging South-East Asia." with Ivailo Arsov, Matthew Bunny and Peter Rickards, *RBA Bulletin*, December 2018.

Research assistantships

RA for Moritz Lenel (Princeton)	*2023 – 2025*
RA for Gianluca Violante (Princeton) and Felipe Alves (Bank of Canada)	*2022*
RA for Markus Brunnermeier (Princeton)	*2021*

Teaching

Princeton University, Teaching Assistant

ECO981 Junior Independent Work	*2024 – 2025, 2025 – 2026*
ECO302 Econometrics	*Spring 2024, Spring 2025*
ECO312 Econometrics: A Mathematical Approach	*Fall 2023*
SPI512c Macroeconomics for Policymakers (Advanced), Tutor	*Spring 2022*

The Australian National University, Teaching Assistant

ECON1102 Macroeconomics 1	*Second semester 2017*
ECON1101 Microeconomics 1	*First semester 2017*

Other positions

Reserve Bank of Australia

Visiting Researcher, Economic Research	*Dec 2023 – Jan 2024, Aug 2026*
Senior Analyst, Financial Stability and Domestic Markets	*2020 – 2021*
Analyst, Financial Stability	*2019*
Graduate Economist, Economic Analysis	*2018 – 2019*
Intern, Economic Analysis	*Dec 2016 – Feb 2017*

Awards, scholarships and fellowships

Federal Reserve Bank of New York PhD Fellowship	*Summer 2026*
Princeton University Griswold Center Graduate Student Fellowship	*2025 – 2026*
Princeton University International Economics Section Summer Fellowship	*Summer 2023*
Princeton University J. Edward Lundy *40 Fellowship for Economics	*2021 – 2022*
ANU University Medal	*2017*
ANU Economics Society Prize for Economics IV (Honours)	*2017*
ANU College of Business and Economics Goldman Sachs JBWere Prize	*2017*
ANU Research School of Economics Bob Gregory Scholarship	*2017*

Professional activities

Service Organizer of the Princeton Macro Informal Student Workshop (2024 – 2025)

Workshops Philadelphia Fed Mentoring & Advancing PhDs Program (2025), Becker Friedman Institute Macro Finance Research Program Summer Session (2024), NBER Heterogeneous-Agent Macro Workshop (2023)

Citizenship

Australia (E-3 visa eligible)

Last updated: October 2026